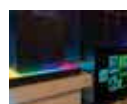




Samsung Odyssey Neo G8
Samsung reveal the Odyssey Neo G8, the world's first 240Hz 4K gaming monitor at CES.
<https://digit.in/jan22-23>



Alienware Concept Nyx
Alienware concept Nyx will let you game on multiple screens at the same time.
<https://digit.in/jan22-24>

DIZO Buds Z Pro

Value for money TWS with a few chinks in its armour

'A'ctive Noise Cancellation without breaking the bank' seemed to be the theme going around in the TWS market in 2021 and that has spilled over into 2022 as well. And boy, are we glad! We love that budget audio manufacturers are taking on the mantle of democratising premium features such as ANC for the masses. DIZO, a brand under the Realme TechLife ecosystem, has already seen some success in the budget ANC TWS area with the DIZO GoPods. Now, we've got that now with the newly-launched DIZO Buds Z Pro with ANC. Let's see how it performs.

BUILD, DESIGN, AND COMFORT

The DIZO Buds Z Pro's charging case and earbuds have a glossy texture. The glossy textured case attracts a lot of fingerprints. The charging case of the DIZO Buds Z Pro is very compact. The front houses the DIZO logo along with an LED indicator light. On the bottom, you have a USB Type-C charging port.

The earbuds have a stem design and they are pretty lightweight. The stems have a shiny effect that will definitely stand out in a crowd.

Since the earbuds weigh merely 3.9g each, they're supremely comfortable to wear over long periods of time. The earbuds stay put during most activities such as walking, running and even exercising. Overall, the buds are comfortable and have a very snug fit.

FEATURES

Being the upgraded version of the DIZO Buds Z, the Pro variant incorporates Active Noise Cancellation which was absent in the older variant. In our tests, the Active Noise Cancellation performance proved to be pretty decent. It subdues low, constant sounds such as an AC's hum, an airplane's drone, and a PC's whirring sound. It



won't, however, diminish higher-frequency sounds such as human voices and high-speed fans. For the price though, it is pretty decent.

A stellar feature on the DIZO Buds Z Pro is Realme Link app support. The app is very versatile and provides EQ presets to choose from, noise cancellation modes, customisable controls, quick toggles for volume enhancer mode and game mode, and battery status for the earbuds.

The touch controls on the earbuds are really unreliable and finicky. We faced many misreadings, as well as the controls completely failing to be read at times. The touch controls allow you to control music playback and calls. Lastly, the earbuds are rated IPX4 water-resistant which make them suitable to be used when exercising.

PERFORMANCE

The DIZO Buds Z Pro are equipped with 10mm drivers. The buds support only the SBC codec, which is disappointing. However, the company has definitely re-tuned these earbuds. They offer a more balanced and smooth sound signature as compared to the DIZO Buds Z. The bass is still boosted but the mids and highs aren't as over-

emphasised, so the resulting sound is more pleasant to listen to. The bass response is slightly bloated, however, the mid-range from is very well produced. Vocals are crystal clear and lead instruments sound pristine, which is excellent for sub-2K TWS earphones.

Moving on to microphone performance, the DIZO Buds Z Pro employs dual microphones with Environmental Noise Cancellation. The microphone performs very well indoors with crisp-sounding voices being relayed, however, when you're outdoors with a lot of ambient noise.

BATTERY LIFE

The DIZO Buds Z that launched in 2021 disappointed us with its paltry 16 hours of playtime, however, the Buds Z Pro has rectified that.

These buds come with a total battery life of 25 hours. You get 7 hours of wireless playback on a single charge from the earbuds. In our tests, with ANC turned on and the volume set to 60 per cent, we got about 5.5 hours of playback.



BUILD	69
FEATURES	70
PERFORMANCE	70
VALUE	73

VERDICT

The DIZO Buds Z Pro democratises ANC for the masses. They compete with a few other earbuds that have done the same such as the Realme Buds Air 2, Redmi Earbuds 3 Pro and the Noise Air Buds. The DIZO Buds Z stand somewhere in the middle of the pack when it comes to performance. With their bloated bass response, they don't perform as well as the Realme Buds Air 2, but they do match up to most other competitors. Overall, they are pretty good TWS buds under 3K.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

COLOURS: Orange Black, Ocean Blue | EARBUD WEIGHT: 3.9g each | CHARGING CASE WEIGHT: 36.9g | DRIVER: 10mm dynamic driver | NOISE-CANCELLING: Feedforward ANC | MICROPHONE: Dual microphones with noise cancelling for calls | BATTERY (EARPHONES): 43mAh | BATTERY (CHARGING CASE): 380mAh

CONTACT

DIZO | PHONE: 1800 843 3030 | EMAIL: service.in@dizo.net | WEBSITE: <https://www.dizo.net/>